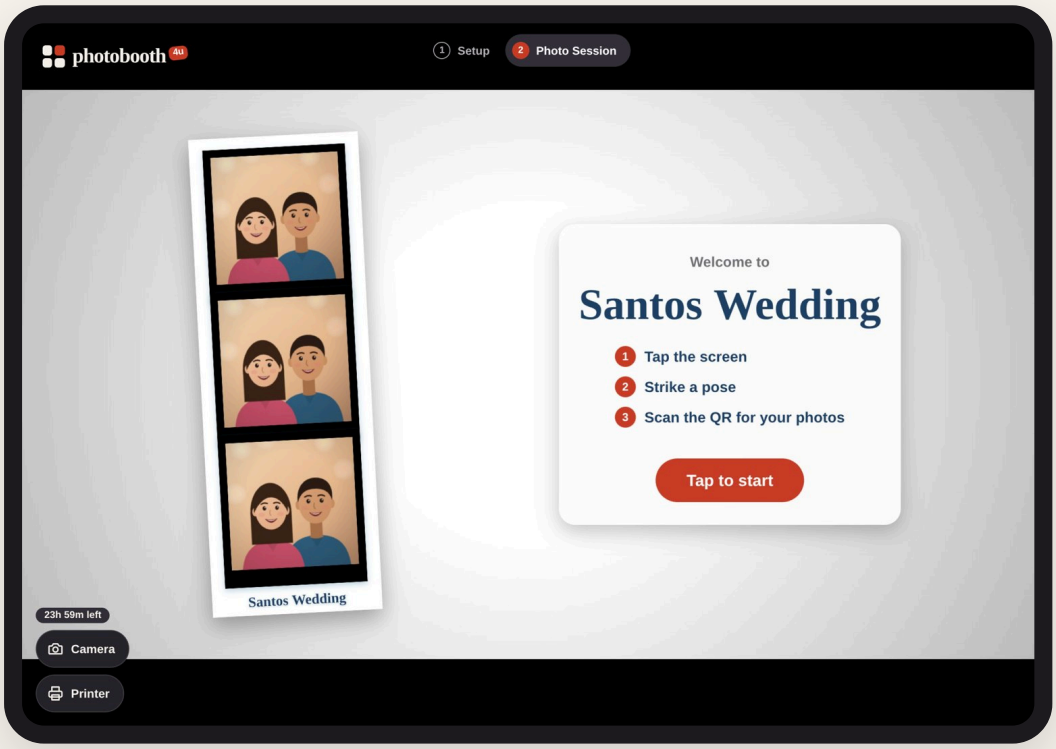
photobooth 4u

# Your tablet, *ready* to be a booth.

How to run photobooth4u on an **iPad or Android tablet**: settings, camera, printing and keeping guests in the booth. In a hurry? **Page 2 is a one-page quick start** for event day.





★ Quick start (page 2)

01 What you need

02 Prepare the tablet

03 Open & unlock the booth

04 Camera & position

05 Guest-only mode

06 Printing from a tablet

07 Weak or no internet

08 After the event

09 Troubleshooting & help

★ EVENT DAY

# Quick start

Do these in order. Each step has its own page if you need more detail.

1. **Charge and mount the tablet**

   Tablet on its charger, on a stand at the guests' eye level, **screen and front camera facing the guests**. Landscape works best. *(Page 5)*

2. **Check the tablet settings**

   Screen never locks, **Do Not Disturb** on, Low Power / Battery Saver off, volume up for the countdown beeps. *(Page 3)*

3. **Connect to the internet**

   Venue Wi-Fi, a pocket Wi-Fi or a phone hotspot. If you print over Wi-Fi, put the **printer on the same network**. *(Pages 7–8)*

4. **Open the booth**

   **iPad:** Safari. **Android:** Chrome. Go to **photobooth4u.netlify.app**. The tablet is already unlocked from last time. Tap **Allow** if it asks for the camera. *(Page 4)*

5. **Check Setup**

   Design, name and date, layout. Lifetime codes: type the **event name** in **6 Share**. Your last setup is saved, so usually you only change the name.

6. **Printer (if your package has printing)**

   Tap **Printer** (bottom left), pick the paper size, then do one test print and choose your printer in the print sheet. Optional: **Print automatically after each session**. *(Page 7)*

7. **Do one test session**

   Take a session yourself, **scan the QR with your phone**, and check the print.

8. **Lock it for guests**

   Turn on **Lock booth** (if included) and **Guided Access** (iPad) or **App pinning** (Android) so guests stay in the booth. Open **Photo Session**. You're ready. *(Page 6)*

### Good habits

- Keep the booth open in **one tab**. Don't close it while photos are uploading.
- Wipe the front camera lens before guests arrive.

### If something goes wrong

- Camera black or frozen: **reload the page**. Your setup is saved.
- Still stuck: page 9, or message us.

01 · BEFORE YOU START

# What you need

MUST HAVE

- **iPad** or **Android tablet**, kept up to date. A phone works too.
- **Tablet stand or tripod mount** at eye level
- **Charger** and a long cable or extension cord
- **Internet**: venue Wi-Fi, pocket Wi-Fi or a phone hotspot

NICE TO HAVE

- **Ring light** or soft light facing the guests
- **Photo printer** on Wi-Fi (e.g. Canon Selphy), if your package has printing
- A printed **QR sign** for the table (page 8)
- A backdrop and props

02 · ONCE PER TABLET

# Prepare the tablet

So the screen never sleeps and no pop-ups land on top of the booth during the event.

IPAD

- **Settings → Display & Brightness → Auto-Lock → Never**
- **Control Centre → Focus → Do Not Disturb** (no message pop-ups)
- **Settings → Battery → Low Power Mode**: off
- **Settings → Apps → Safari → Camera → Allow** (on older iPadOS: Settings → Safari → Camera)
- **Control Centre → Rotation Lock**: on, once the iPad is the right way round
- Brightness and volume up

ANDROID

- **Settings → Display → Screen timeout**: the longest
- **Quick settings → Do Not Disturb**: on
- **Settings → Battery → Battery saver / Power saving**: off
- **Play Store → Chrome → Update**
- **Quick settings → Auto-rotate**: off, once the tablet is the right way round
- Brightness and volume up

While the booth is open it keeps the screen awake by itself. The settings above are the backup, for example after you switch apps.

03 · FIRST TIME ON EACH TABLET

# Open & unlock the booth

1. **Open the website**

   **iPad:** Safari. **Android:** Chrome. Go to **photobooth4u.netlify.app**.

2. **Enter your code**

   Type your `PB-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX` code and tap **Unlock**. Lifetime codes open **My Events** first: tap **Open photo booth**.

3. **Allow the camera**

   Tap **Allow** when the tablet asks. The live view appears in Setup.

4. **Next time, just open the website**

   The tablet stays unlocked. Each tablet uses one of your **device slots**. Lifetime codes can see and **remove** devices in **My Events → Your details & devices**.

### Keep it in a normal tab

On an iPad, run the booth in a **Safari tab**. If you added it to the Home Screen, the AirPrint sheet may not open from there.

Don't use **Private browsing** or **Clear History and Website Data**: they sign the tablet out and remove photos still waiting to upload.

EVERY EVENT

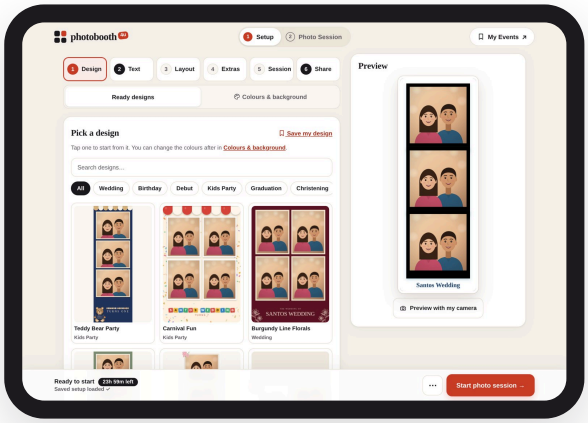
## Set up the event

In **Setup**, go through the 6 steps with **Next**: **Design**, **Text** (name and date), **Layout**, **Extras**, **Session** (countdown, camera, light, lock) and **Share** (event name for lifetime codes, the All photos QR). Then tap **Start photo session**.

Everything saves by itself, and every device on your code gets the same design. More detail: the **Setup guide**, page 4.

**TWO TABLETS AT ONE EVENT?**

Type the **exact same event name** on both. They share one gallery, one QR and one design.




Setup on an iPad: the 6 steps across the top, preview on the right.

04 · LOOKING GOOD

# Camera & position

The booth uses the tablet's **front camera**, so guests see themselves on the screen while they pose. On tablets the session fills the whole screen.

1. ### Height and distance

   Camera at **eye level**, about **1.5–2 m** from the guests. For groups, step the stand back rather than zooming.

2. ### Light in front, not behind

   Light should face the guests. Avoid a bright window behind them. A **ring light** next to the tablet helps a lot.

3. ### Dim room? Use Screen flash

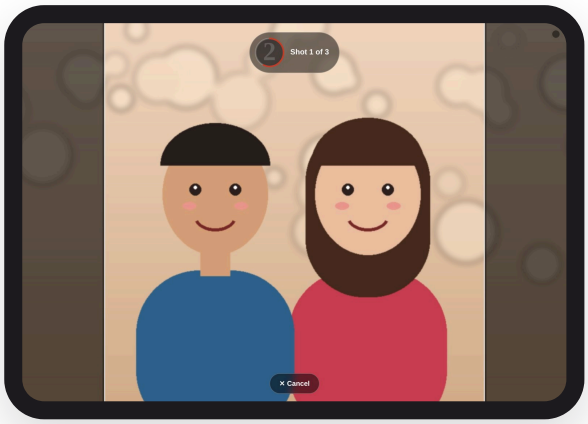
   **Setup → 7 Session → Light, sound and start → Screen flash**: the screen turns white for each photo and lights up faces.

4. ### Mirror

   **Mirror** flips the preview like a mirror. The final photo looks exactly like the preview.

5. ### Choose another camera

   Tap **Camera** (bottom left) to switch. The back camera is sharper but faces away from the screen, so guests can't see themselves.




The countdown fills the screen on a tablet.

## Using your DSLR or a capture card

ANDROID

**Tablet app (recommended): Nikon**, **Canon EOS** and **Sony Alpha** work over USB with **live view and the real shutter**. Plug the camera into the tablet's USB port with a **data** cable (USB-C or an OTG adapter), switch it on and tap **OK** when Android asks to allow it. In the booth pick **Nikon / Canon / Sony camera over USB cable** in the Camera list. **Canon:** Live View shoot on, mode dial P / Tv / Av / M. **Sony:** USB Connection → **PC Remote**. **Nikon:** PTP / MTP mode. Save as JPEG. Other makes: use the camera's webcam mode or an HDMI capture card. In Chrome instead of the app, use **Camera → DSLR / mirrorless over USB** (test at **photobooth4u.netlify.app/camera-test/**).

IPAD

A DSLR can't be controlled from an iPad. On an **iPad with USB-C** (iPadOS 17 or newer), a **USB webcam or HDMI capture card** can show up in the Camera menu. Test it at home before the event.

05 · SELF-SERVICE BOOTH

# Guest-only mode

Two locks work together: **Lock booth** hides Setup inside photobooth4u, and the tablet's own lock keeps guests from leaving the browser.

1. **Lock booth (if your package has it)**

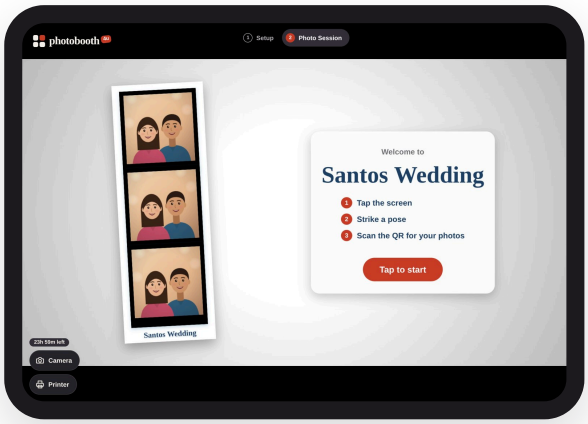
   **Setup → 7 Session → Lock booth**: set a 4-digit **PIN**, then **Lock booth now**. Guests only see start, photos, QR and print. To get back in, tap the **small lock** in the top-right corner and enter the PIN.

2. **iPad: Guided Access**

   **Settings → Accessibility → Guided Access**: on, and set a passcode. Open the booth in Safari, **triple-click the top button** (or the Home button) → **Start**. To end it, triple-click again and enter the passcode.

3. **Android: App pinning**

   **Settings → Security** (or Security & privacy → More security settings) → **App pinning**: on, with "Ask for PIN before unpinning". Open **Recent apps**, tap Chrome's icon → **Pin**. To unpin, hold **Back + Recents** (or swipe up and hold) and enter your PIN.




The welcome screen guests see. Your event name comes from Setup.

## Start without touching

**TAP**

The default. Guests tap the screen to start, and tap again for each photo if you chose **Wait for a tap**.

**WAVE**

Guests wave at the camera to start. **Setup → 7 Session → Light, sound and start → Start**.

**SMILE**

Starts when someone smiles at the camera. Works best with good light on faces.

**Countdown beeps and shutter click** are on by default (same section). Keep the tablet's volume up and the side switch off silent.

06 · IF YOUR PACKAGE INCLUDES PRINTING

# Printing from a tablet

Two ways. Pick the one that matches your printer.

### A · WI-FI PRINTER

**Canon Selphy CP1300 / CP1500**, Epson, HP and other **AirPrint** (iPad) or **Mopria** (Android) printers.

1. Put the printer and the tablet on the **same Wi-Fi**.
2. In the booth tap **Printer**, pick the paper size, and print one test.
3. Choose your printer in the print sheet. The tablet remembers it.
4. Optional: **Print automatically after each session**. The print sheet then opens by itself and the guest just taps **Print**.

**Android:** if no printer shows, install **Mopria Print Service** or **Canon Print Service** from the Play Store and turn it on.

### B · LAPTOP PRINT STATION

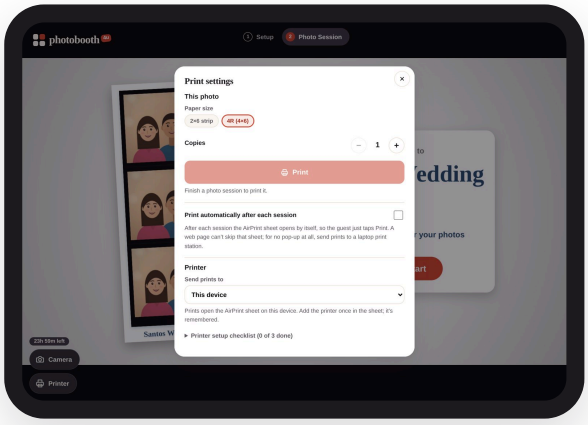
For **DNP / HiTi** printers (not AirPrint), or when guests shouldn't see a print sheet.

1. On the laptop next to the printer, open the **Print Helper** and **photobooth4u.netlify.app/print-station/**, sign in with your code, and pick a printer for each size.
2. On the tablet: **Printer → Send prints to → Laptop print station**. The booth shows when the station is on.
3. Prints go to the laptop and print with **no pop-up**, including Print automatically.

**Free trial:** the tablet shows a 6-digit **pairing code**; type it on the print-station page.

### SELPHY TIPS

- **No venue Wi-Fi?** Connect the Selphy and the tablet to the **same pocket Wi-Fi or phone hotspot**. The Selphy's own direct Wi-Fi has no internet, so photos would only upload later.
- Choose the **Canon Selphy postcard (100×148 mm)** size. Strip layouts print two strips on one postcard to cut.
- About **40 seconds per print**: plan 1 print per session at busy events.
- Lifetime codes choose their paper sizes and print limits in **My Events → Printing**.




Printer: paper size, Print automatically, and where prints go.

07 · WHEN THE VENUE'S INTERNET IS BAD

# Weak or no internet

1. **Open the booth while you're online**

   Load the booth and check Setup before the event starts, while the internet works.

2. **Keep going if it drops**

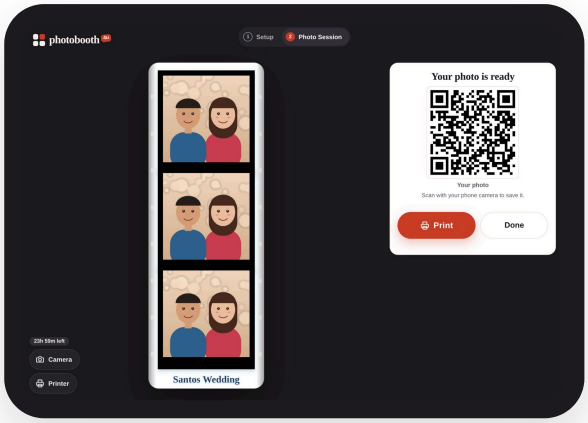
   Sessions carry on. Each photo is **kept on the tablet** and uploads by itself when the internet is back. Guests still get their QR: *"Scan now · your photo arrives once the booth is back online."*

3. **Put out the QR sign**

   **Setup → 6 Share → Download QR sign**, then print it for the table. Guests can scan it any time to see every photo of the event.

4. **Keep the tab open until it's empty**

   The Photo Session panel shows **Waiting to upload**. Leave the booth open on internet until that list is gone.




After each session: the guest's own QR, Print and Done.

**Guest payments:** QR payment needs internet; **vouchers work offline**. With "QR + vouchers" the booth switches to vouchers by itself when the internet drops. Setup guide pages 9–10.

08 · AFTER THE EVENT

# Send the photos to your client

1. **Open My Events**

   In Setup, tap **My Events ↗** (top right): it opens already signed in. Or use **photobooth4u.netlify.app/lifetime/** on any phone.

2. **Copy the link or show the QR**

   Send the **online gallery** by Messenger. Your client can **Download all** there.

**7-DAY RULE**

Photos are deleted **7 days after the event's last photo**. Send the link the same day.

09 · QUICK FIXES

# Troubleshooting

| PROBLEM | FIX |
|---|---|
| **"We need access to your camera"** | **iPad:** Settings → Apps → Safari → Camera → Allow, then reload. **Android:** tap the icon left of the address → Permissions → Camera → Allow, then reload. |
| **Camera black or frozen** | Usually after switching apps or a call. **Reload the page**. Close other apps that use the camera. |
| **The screen dims or locks** | iPad: Auto-Lock → Never. Android: Screen timeout to the longest. Keep the tablet charging. |
| **Messages or calls pop up** | Turn on **Do Not Disturb** before the event. |
| **Guests leave the booth or open other apps** | Use **Guided Access** (iPad) or **App pinning** (Android), plus **Lock booth**. Page 6. |
| **No print sheet appears (iPad)** | Open the booth in a **Safari tab**, not from a Home Screen icon. Or use a laptop print station. |
| **Printer isn't in the list** | Same Wi-Fi as the tablet? Restart the printer. Android: install **Mopria** or **Canon Print Service**. |
| **"Already used on another device"** | All device slots are taken. Lifetime: **My Events → Your details & devices → Remove** an old one. Otherwise message us. |
| **"Photos waiting to upload"** | The internet dropped. Keep the booth open: they upload by themselves, or tap **Retry now**. |
| **The QR code doesn't appear** | Check the internet, and that the event name is set in **Setup → 6 Share**. |
| **Forgot your code** | **My Events → Forgot your code?** It's emailed to the address on your account. |
| **Countdown is silent** | Volume up, side switch off silent, and **Countdown beeps** on in Setup → 7 Session. |

### Before every event

- ☐ Tablet charged, charger packed
- ☐ Booth opens and the camera works
- ☐ Printer on the same Wi-Fi, test print done
- ☐ Do Not Disturb on, Auto-Lock: Never
- ☐ Event name set in Setup → 6 Share
- ☐ QR sign printed for the table

## Need help? Message us.

We're on Facebook Messenger: **m.me/roktetnachi**

Message us